Mana Hauā Policy

māori

Executive Summary

Mana Hauā relates to the life force and the inherent value of Māori disabled.

Whānau Hauā and Māori disabled are terms used in relation to whānau with physical, mental, intellectual, or sensory impairments.

Te Pāti Māori dreams and aspirations are to achieve tino rangatiratanga for whānau, hapū and iwi. This policy is a strength based kaupapa that recognises Mana Hauā and seeks to assert the rights and wellbeing of Whānau Hauā within our whānau, hapū and iwi.

Te Pāti Māori will:

- Establish a Mana Hauā Authority
- Reallocate 25% of all Disability funding to the Māna Hauā Authority
- Establish Kaupapa Māori disability organisations and rehabilitation facilities.
- Abolish ACC and establish a Māori ACC Authority.
- Ensure that Māori disability organisations are formally included in the development of all disability-related policy and legislation
- Reform building standards to require that all new housing builds are fully accessible
- Remove all barriers for Tangata Hauā to access health services
- Ensure that antenatal screening programmes are not biased towards termination of pregnancies if a disability is diagnosed
- Recognise Te Reo Rotarota as an official language in Aotearoa
- Require te reo Māori proficiency to be assessed in NZSL qualifications
- Provide pathways for te reo Māori speakers to learn Te Reo Rotarota and NZSL
- Abolish abatement rates on benefits for Tangata Hauā and their care workers
- Immediately abolish the minimum wage exemption for Tangata Hauā

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Context

Māori directly or indirectly experience disability at a higher rate than any other population group in Aotearoa. Despite one in three Māori having some form of disability, Māori have less access to support and health and disability services.

The pandemic and natural disasters have highlighted major racism and inequity that impacts on wellbeing of whānau hauā. Statistics show the inequity of services for Māori disabled.

The current environment sees an increase in costs for housing, transport, food, and other requirements. An environment that makes the lives of Whānau Hauā worse than they were must not be tolerated. There are growing concerns that Tangata Hauā are being treated as economic burdens - mistreated, abused, and systematically targeted by government organisations and Crown agencies.

The evidence for this across the whole of government is best identified by our access to employment, education, housing, cultural access, transport, healthcare, government funding and whānau relationships plus the inaccessible attitudes within government and organisational structures.

Based on Te Pae Mahutonga – Mauri ora (Cultural identity and access to the Māori world), Waiora (Environmental Protection), Toiora (Healthy Lifestyles), Ngā Manukura (Leadership) me te Mana Whakahaere (Autonomy), Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Whānau Hauā and have put forward a range of solutions to improve outcomes for Tangata Hauā in Aotearoa.

Solutions

Mokopuna Hauā

Te Pāti Māori assert the inherent value of Mokopuna Hauā and their role in Te Ao Marama as creators, innovators, and models of change.

It has been shown that as the wellbeing of indigenous and disabled whānau are improved, the outcomes for everyone improves substantially. Both Māori and non-Māori disabled children face discrimination from birth.

Te Pāti Māori support Māori disabled children receiving all supports necessary from whānau, hapū and iwi to access their environment whether it is schools,

hospitals, funding, accessible equipment, interpreters, and specialists to ensure they have what's needed to live a full life.

Māori have no official presence at the Disabled Peoples' Organisations table, yet despite the existence of Te Ao Marama Aotearoa (TAMA) the only pan tribal and pan disability Roopu, they are denied a voice at the table by the predominantly non-disabled led Disabled Peoples' Organisations, currently around the table. This is a breach of the United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (UNCRPD) and Tiriti rights.

We will double funding for the Enabling Good Lives approach administered by the Ministry of Social Development and reallocate $35 million to Māori disability organisations.

We will also ensure that Māori disability organisations are formally included in the development of all disability-related policy and legislation

Hauora

Te Pāti Māori assert that all barriers must be removed for Tangata Hauā to access timely, accessible, and affordable health services.

Whānau Hauā have the right to access cultural avenues of hauora in addition to the medical and or the psychological model.

The American Medical Association model of practice, which is deeply embedded into ACC, is economically driven rather than being people-focussed. Kaupapa Māori practices place whānau hauā at the centre along with their whānau, hapū and iwi. Te Pāti Māori will ensure equity of service provision between ACC and Ministry of Health, as these systems currently discriminate against people born with disabilities compared to those with accident-related injuries. This will ensure fair application and enforcement of the Act and Regulations, as we would create policies based on an Aotearoa New Zealand model of practice that is people- and community-focussed.

The End of Life Choice Act does not have sufficient safeguards to ensure that Whānau Hauā are not targeted by this legislation, as they predominantly have less access to support and health and disability services. Amendments should be made to Act and quality of life should be the first priority. There has also been no cultural lens placed on this policy and so no cultural process outlined for

Māori or indeed other cultures who would like this but given with a cultural focus.

Medical decisions must be based on quality of life for whānau hauā, with requests by them and their whānau being acknowledged and actioned.

We will work with Māori disability organisations to ensure that antenatal screening programmes are not biased towards termination of pregnancies if a disability is diagnosed.

Mahi

Whānau Hauā have high levels of unemployment due to inaccessible workplaces, economic situations, mistreatment by government agencies and employers' definitions of work. They are often seen as economic burdens.

Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Whānau Hauā to participate in an accessible workforce without fear of discrimination or prejudice.

We will immediately abolish the minimum wage exemption for Tangata Hauā, rather than delaying this until 2025 like the current government is doing.

More employment roles need to be developed based on whānau hauā skills and expertise. Many Tangata Hauā would prefer to work, but the lack of flexibility amongst employers can create barriers.

Te Pāti Māori also acknowledge that for many Tangata Hauā, paid employment will remain inaccessible. We will therefore ensure that the welfare system upholds their mana.

The institutionalised racism and prejudice and ongoing mistreatment by management and staff within WINZ towards Whānau Hauā needs to be addressed.

We will abolish abatement rates on benefits for Tangata Hauā and their care workers. They create unnecessary financial stress for Whānau Hauā, their partners, and their carers. Tangata Hauā having their financial supports removed because they seek a relationship with a non-disabled partner or spouse is unfair, unjust, and cruel.

Whare

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Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Whānau Hauā to be housed in safe, accessible, and affordable housing in the community of their choice.

We will reform building standards to require that all new housing builds are fully accessible. We will also retrofit existing public housing to meet universal design standards and provide funding to papakāinga who wish to apply universal design standards to their whare.

Te Reo Rotarota

Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Mana Turi to have all the support needed to fully participate in society.

Statistics New Zealand says hearing impairment affects nine percent of the New Zealand's total population, 54,000 being Māori.

However, qualified signers, who can translate in to and from Māori, number around a dozen.

We will recognise Te Reo Rotarota as an official language in Aotearoa, provide scholarships for te reo Māori speakers to learn Te Reo Rotarota and NZSL, and require te reo Māori proficiency to be assessed in NZSL qualifications.

Ahurea

Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Whānau Hauā as valued members of their whānau, hapū and iwi.

Inclusion of whānau hauā in tikanga Māori improves hauora and enriches our culture as Tangata Whenua.

Te Pāti Māori assert rights and accessibility for wheelchair users and all Tangata Hauā in our cultural spaces, including marae. This includes that that female NZSL and Te Reo Rotarota interpreters should be able to speak on behalf of male Mana Turi as they are kaiāwhina for Māori Deaf to communicate with.

All national Māori events such as Te Matatini and Ngā Manu Kōrero should be accessible for Whānau Hauā.

Hākinakina

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Te Pāti Māori assert the rights of Whānau Hauā to participate in sports.

We would set up funding streams for Māori disabled sports clubs and promotional schemes to increase Whānau Hauā participation in both non-disabled and disabled sports groups. For example, we would ensure funding is allocated to waka ama clubs that promote whakawhānaungatanga with Whānau Hauā in teams and events.

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Kuputaka

- Mana Hauā – life force and the inherent value of Māori disabled
- Whānau Hauā – Māori disabled in relation to whānau with physical, mental, intellectual, or sensory impairments within our whānau, hapū and iwi
- Tangata Hauā – people with disabilities
- Tino Rangatiratanga - self-determination, sovereignty, autonomy, self-government, domination, rule, control, power
- Kaupapa – topic, policy, matter for discussion, plan, purpose, scheme, proposal, agenda, subject, programme, theme, issue, initiative
- Whānau – extended family, family group, a familiar term of address to a number of people - the primary economic unit of traditional Māori society. In the modern context the term is sometimes used to include friends who may not have any kinship ties to other members
- Hapū – kinship group, clan, tribe, subtribe
- Iwi – extended kinship group, tribe, nation, people, nationality, race
- Te Reo Rotarota – Maori sign language
- Mokopuna Hauā – children with disabilities
- Te Ao Marama – The World of Light
- Te Pae Māhutonga – A Model for Māori Health Promotion
- Hauora – health, vigour
- Mahi – work, employment